Keep Burning: Design Document

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Project Overview

Keep Burning is an endless corridor-style survival runner developed in Unity.

The player controls a living flame moving forward through procedurally generated environments while managing fuel, avoiding hazards, and rescuing trapped boys. The main goal is to survive as long as possible while keeping the flame alive.

The game is built around a continuous risk-reward loop. Fuel decreases over time, creating constant survival pressure, while rescuing snowmen and collecting fuel pickups provide recovery opportunities.
The narrative is directly connected to gameplay: the flame represents life and persistence, fuel represents survival time, and rescuing snowmen symbolizes restoring hope in a frozen world.

Game Mechanics

Core Loop

- Automatically run forward through an endless corridor
- Control horizontal movement and jumping
- Avoid hazards and rescue boys forzen into snowmen through different maps
- Fuel decreases over time which equals to live time
- Collect fuel pickups and use extra lives to survive longer
- Each successful rescueing brings one eatra life
- When the player dies, one extra life is consumed and fuel is fully restored

Fuel System

Fuel decreases continuously during gameplay and directly affects the flame's visual intensity.
When fuel reaches zero, the flame is extinguished unless the player has an extra life available.

Goals and Rewards System

- Rescuing snowmen gives the player extra lives and points
- Points are saved between different runs
- Before starting a new game, players can spend points to buy an extra life

Map and Difficulty

- The map is generated using a procedural chunk-based system

- Each play is unique, because maps are adding randomly
- Ice surfaces create inertia-based movement and slower control response

Hazards

- Water causes the flame to extinguish
- Obstacles affect movement and increase difficulty
- Moving out of bounds causes immediate failure

Platform Support

The game runs on both PC (MacOs) and Android platforms.
The Android version is built as an APK and includes mobile touch controls for movement and jumping.
Core gameplay remains the same across both platforms, while the control method is adapted.

Future Improvements

The project is being expected to expand with backend systems and long-term progression features.

Adding Database

- Store player scores using Firebase Realtime Database is a good idea
- Synchronize user records and update data in realtime

Leaderboard System

- Create a global real-time ranking system
- Track and display the best scores of all players

Buff / Gacha System
To improve replayability, a random buff system could be added, buff like:

- 3 x score but reduced vision
- 2 x score but only one life
- Slower fuel decay